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In This Issue:

1. From the Chief Editor's Desk
2. Depiction of the unison of shiva and shakti in the canto-*shariram twam shambho*, of the Saundarya Lahari according to the commentaries of *laxmidhara*, etc. Dr. Arati Sharma.
3. Pratyabhijna Hridayam Made Easy 2nd aphorism [by *Swami Parananda*]
4. Wisdom from Shiva's rattle-drum 13th aphorism
5. Poem and pics by prof Ambika Talwar



From the Chief Editor's Desk

The discursive lineage of the six schools of philosophy always had an underlying streamline of mystic awareness. Which focused more on the propagation of experience part of the canons. These were handed over from generation to generation of mystics through viva voce and the lineage of Shakti pat or induction of psychic power into the novice which helped the aspirant experience the music phenomena and spiritual states by himself. All Six philosophies viz *viasesika Samkhya and yoga, Purva meemansa and uttaramemansa* were affiliated to the four cloistral institutions. Since these aphorisms pertain to high and subtle experiences of yoga, the underlying discursive principle turns out to be the doctrine of yoga. The aphoristic yoga philosophy gradually modified into the arcane tradition of the agamas which emphasise more on directly sharing the experience of the preceptor through what can be called tantric shortcuts. Strangely enough, unlike all other doctrines, we don't find an uninterrupted lineage of the practitioners of Patanjali's school of yoga. The lineage may have been arcane and meticulously concealed to ward off dilettante and meddlers. The inclusion of obscurantism can be justified due to a very subtle and introverted nature of the experience which might get deflected by the very presence of an intruder. Impediments as they have been named in Patanjali's aphorism mean this from an etymological standpoint. अंतरायः something or somebody that just creeps in casually. From physical ailments to lethargy, sloth, or any of their agency any impeding factor in any stage or limb of yoga can be an antarya or impediment. Excluding neo yoga which focuses mainly on fitness and age delaying, the main authentic yoga of Patanjali aims at salvation (called isolation or kaivalya). Ailments, stupor, sloth, lethargy, indulgence, hallucination etc. The governesses of peethas are furious entities who are committed to exclude the unbecoming and incompetent aspirants from entering cloistral institutions-even mentally.

पीठेश्वर्यः महाघोराः मोहयन्ति मुहुर्मुहुः।

Only enlightened beings who are also men of consideration erudition have access to them. An *avadhoota* is an emancipated being who is exempted from all cloistral or monastic obligation. अव्यक्तलिङ्गिनं दृष्ट्वा सम्भाषन्ते मरीचयः the projections of the *chit shakti* communicate with such an adept who is not recognised by any of his external paraphernalia or insignia. The coincidental conference of one such a seer with the goddess of esoteric institution leads to the revelation and propagation of this mystic tradition in the form of thirteen aphorisms that have all the mystic and yogic wisdom encrypted in them. Agamic Aphorisms are rather obscurant encryptions which unlike as they are defined in the conventional lore of discursive knowledge as “easy to comprehend and without ambiguity” etc., are impossible to be decoded without the help of a commentary by a scholar who comes from the same tradition. The biggest epistemological aberration in viva voce tradition or *vakra amnaya* is the lack of relevance of scriptural authority. It depends on the elaboration of a pre ascertained postulation within the parameters of discursive compilations. सिद्धिदा गुरुवागेव सर्वे ग्रन्थाविडम्बकाः।

There have been several turning points in the history of eastern metaphysics when exposition by preceptors came to be more authentic than original aphorisms. This trend generated what Anant Shakti refers to as *Vikramnaya*. One illustrious monk [Madhusudan Saraswath] says in one of his expositions on Adi Shankara's. Dashshloki that he does not regard the dictum of Vyasa the compiler of Brahma sutras as much as he does that of Bhasykara Adishankara. The speciality of these aphorisms is that these are the “unwritten Via Voce compilations of the adepts of the yore based on their mystic experience. These are encrypted to facilitate the propagation of their religious experience through an uninterrupted lineage of yogins. The arcane doctrine was imparted to Niskriyanand Nath by Gandh Madan Siddha while initiating him and was received from Vatulnath and came down to Anant Shakti who as it were seems to be comparatively recent. Without his exposition,

these encryptions would have been obscure and without much utilitarian import. The crux has been elaborated in the last sutra. It has the details of transcending the first vowel ॐ which pervades all alphabets and therefore all that can be expressed physically or mentally. The energy generated by word transcendence through this means leading to unison and assimilation into the essential nature.

Swami Paranand Tirth
Founder president CEO
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- अल्पाक्षरमसन्दिग्धं सारवद्विश्चतो मुखम्। अस्तोभमनवयं च सूत्रं सूत्रविदो विदुः।



A Depiction of the unison of Shiva and Shakti in the canto “*Shriram tvam shambho*” of Soundarya Lahari according to the commentaries of Lakshmidharacharya etc.

**[*English rendering of a Sanskrit paper read by Dr. Arati Sharma at the annual colloquium of YTA
Yoga Tantra and agama [inc.]*]**

Acharya Shankara while felicitating the supreme power, who is always in perpetual unison with Shiva, propounded their unity in the very propitiatory verse of his hymn named Soundarya Lahari. He felicitates her as the vibrant power of consciousness of the self-evident principle i.e. Lord Shiva.

शिवः शक्त्या युक्तो यदि भवति शक्तः प्रभवितुं
न चेदेवं देवो न खलु कुशलः स्पन्दितुमपि।
अतस्त्वामाराध्यां हरिहरविरिञ्चादिभिरपि
प्रणन्तुं स्तोतुं वा कथमकृतपुण्यः प्रभवति ॥

[It's not possible for Shiva to be active when devoid of his Shakti. He cannot even move even a bit without her. Therefore, how can a man with no meritorious deed, be able to make obeisance or felicitate you to who is adored even by the trinity gods? Viz Brahma the creator, Vishnu the sustainer, and Shiva the annihilator.]

When it comes to an exposition of the present anthology, we find that the sixteenth *Kala* or *shodashi* is referred to by the name *Sundari* or *Shri Sundari lit.* The beauteous one or the graceful and beauteous one. The oscillation beatitude of this beauteous Shri Sundari has been named as Soundarya Lahari. This Soundarya Lahari besides being an anthology of psalms for adoration also serves the purpose of guiding spiritual practices, owing to the mystic secrets of spiritual pursuits encrypted in these cantos.

The present canto aims at establishing the union of Shiva and Shakti

शरीरं त्वं शम्भोः शशिमिहिरवक्षोरुहयुगं
तवात्मानं मन्ये भगवति नवात्मानमनघम्।
अतः शेषःशेषीत्ययमुभयसाधारणतया
स्थितः सम्बन्धो वां समरमपरानन्दपरयोः॥

“O goddess! You are the embodiment of the absolute principle - the Shiva as the universe with the sun and the moon as your breasts.” The semiotics of the sun and moon as breasts are consistent since Anand Bhairav, the absolute principle in this context is conditioned within the *Kala vyuha* [the formation time conditioning] sun and moon being the agency of regulating the course of time. Another interpretation can be, you are the body of Shiva with your breasts as the sun and the moon - since Shiva is bodiless.

The essential nature is that Shiva is conditioned in nine-fold vyuhas or configurations. The relationship between bliss and the object of bliss or Shiva and Shakti is equally applicable as *shesh* the residue and *sheshi* the residual. Both shesh and sheshi are mutually related like attributes and the attributed because both are interdependent and owing to being unrelated and are also partial or incomplete. The unison and thus, homogeneity of both is an evident use to their non-duel nature like that of sweetness and sugar. This body [of Shiva] or let's say embodiment, is esoteric in as much as it is the union of consciousness and bliss or the absolute Brahma and his Shakti. The mystery behind the metaphor of the sun and the moon as two breasts is - that the universe is sustained by *prana* or spirit which emanates from the solar principle and *soma rasa* or propitiating fluid which flows from the moon.

In this canto, the conjugal of Shiva and Shakti have been specifically enunciated as the edifice and caricature. Shiva has nine configurations viz *kaala*, *kula*, *nama*, *jnanna*, *chitta*, *nada*, *bindu*, *kalaa*, and *jiva*. There are

nine manifestations of Shakti as their Shaivites counterparts viz. *vama, jyeshtha, raudri, ambika, ichha, jnana, kriya, shanti, and para*. From these nine triangles [4 shikantha and 5 shivayuvati] the Shri chakra supreme empress of the universe springs forth. The Shri chakra is formed by triangles, angle circles and squares in the subtle form of the goddess. Their union i.e. the unison of consciousness and bliss is, in fact, the union of the absolute brahman and his Shakti.

In this context, the inseparability of Shiva and Shakti has been propounded by various commentators of Soundarya Lahari in their own ways. They are *Lakshmidhara, Saubhagyavardhini, Arunamodini, Anand Giri, Tatparya dipini, Padarthchandrika, Dindim, Gopal sundry, Anandlahari, and Kaivalyavardhini*.

In this paper, we are pursuing on the lines of commentary by Lakshmidhara and others. Lakshmidhara explains the purport of this canto as follows:

Thou Anand Bhairavi is the embodiment of Shiva as Anand bhairav. I know you as your universal manifestation with the sun and moon as you two breasts. Bhagwati o - the feminine gender of Bhagwan or god has been defined as an entity who has bhaga [good fortune].

One who knows the origin and dissolution of all beings, their course of origin and disappearance, ignorance, and wisdom is called Bhagwan. Bhagvati is the feminine gender of Bhagwan. Since you possess all these virtues like origin etc. hence Bhagvati.

We have already mentioned the nine-fold manifestations or vyuhas of Anand bhairav.

1. Kaala vyuha is the time gradation beginning from a fraction or names unto *Kalpa* or eon. Since the moon and sun are also conditioned within the time, they are said to be within the limitation of kaala vyuha.
2. Kula vyuha refers to perceptions like blue, etc.
3. Nama vyuha is names or novena.
4. Jnana vyuha is a collective experience or *Vijnana*. Another name of this vyuha is *bhaga vyuha*. This bhaga vyuha is further two-fold sabhag and vibhaga. The former is *savikalpa* or with ideations and the latter is *nirvibhaga* or without ideations.
5. Chitta vyuha contains the five entities like ego etc. Ego, heart, mind, reason, and collective intelligence i.e. *mahat*.
6. Nada vyuha is the collective of desire attachment nature effort. And all the four modes of speech viz. *para, pashyanti, madhyama, and vaikhari* which refers to the introvert mode of transcendental speech which can be experienced only in a yogic trance.

Kamakalavilasa mentions this phenomenon as,

या सान्तरोहरूपा परा महेशी परा नाम

Para manifests as the three portions of the Sanskrit alphabet, in the form of *panchadashi* with three portions. This very mode of Vak turns onto the Shri Chakra comprising the three khandas. This is an arcane secret of the agamas. This is experienced distinctly in the state of the yogic union.

It has been mentioned in Kamkalavilasa of Punyanand Nath as follows:

या सान्तरोहरूपा परा महेशी परा नाम

The great empress called para manifests in the form of an introverted upsurge. When distinct this comes to be called *Pashyanti*. It has been said in the same canon i.e. *kamala vilasa*. The distinct pashyanti acquires the form of Shri Chakra consisting of the three portions of *matrikas* or the fifteen-syllable mantra.

Owing to the unison of three portions, Shri Chakra and mantra - all three are not different. This is the secret of the tantras. Madhyama is the lower and grosser state of Pashyanti. Madhyama is further classified as two-fold Vama etc. Thus, we have individual vama and collective vama, individual jyeshtha and collective jyeshtha, individual raudri and collective raudri, individual and collective ambika. These four Shakti denoted by the four inverted triangles of the Shri Chakra. The five triangles pointing upwards denote the five Shaktis viz. *ichha, jnana, kriya, shanta, and para* [the powers of desire, action, knowledge, and transcendence]. The supreme goddess is called nine-fold [containing nine vyuhas] since she manifests in above mentioned nine forms.

एका परा तक्ष्ण्यावामादिव्यष्टिमातृसृष्ट्यात्मा।

तेन नमात्मा जाता माता सा मध्यमाभिधानाभ्याम् ॥

द्विविधा हि मध्यमा सा सूक्ष्मा स्थूलाकृतिः स्थिरा सूक्ष्मा।

नवनादमयी स्थूला नवर्गात्मा तु भूतलिप्याख्या॥

आद्या कारणमन्या कार्यं त्वनयोर्यतस्ततो हेतोः।

सैवेयं न हि भेदस्तादात्म्यं हेतुहेतुमदभीष्टम्॥

Single and transcendent means, the equilibrium of the three gunas viz. *sattva, rajas, and tamas*. Pashyanti is different from these when it comes to attributes, madhyama is grosser is presumably beginningless and collective. Para has been understood as the substratum of pashyanti madhyama and vaikhari.

Binduvyuha refers to the agglomeration psychic plexuses. *Kalaa vyuha* pertains to the fifty fractions of *Matrika* or the alphabet. *Jivavyuha* means the experiencer, thus the ninefold vyuhas or formations are further divisible into the form of *bhokta, bhojya, and bhoga* i.e. subjective-objective and bilateral divisions.

Atma vyuha is subjective, kalaa vyuha is objective so on and so forth. According to Tatparya Depani, the verse has been interpreted as follows;

O goddess you are the embodiment of Shiva. According to the Sanskrit etymology of the word *sharira* - it is something that ceases. The breasts of your etherical embodiments are the sun and moon. In this manner, the order of succession has been enunciated. After rejecting the difference caused by conditioning even the difference from the absolute standpoint has been rejected by saying that o Goddess, I maintain that your aforesaid form is the embodiment of Shaiva I.e. in the essential nature you are nothing else but Shiva. The

embodiment is further attributed as *anagham* or taintless. The taint or *agham* is then the veil of ignorance in your essential Shaiva nature and you are unalloyed by them. This is the well-established relationship between you and Shiva which are also known as *paranand* and *para*. The relation of residue and residual [*shesh* and *sheshi*], the example of this relation are sacraments like *prayaja* and *anuyaja*, etc. This relation is a concomitant homogeneity between paranand the all-pervasive and para the conditioned consciousness. The relation is derived as thus - you are the embodiment of Shiva and vice versa i.e. Shiva is your embodiment.

The author of DINDIMA explains this as – O supreme empress you are the only embodiment of Shiva i.e. the absolute brahman. The eternal relation of personification holds good only in the case of Shakti and Shiva i.e. you and your inseparable half. This eternal relationship is not admissible to the votaries of the Samkhya school of thought who propound that only the eternal nature of Prakriti is related to the finite characteristics of multiple experiencers. This relation is eternal only in the case of mahat, etc. owing to the creation and dissolution of the relation in question is transitory in the case of Shiva and Shakti.

Reference:

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2. Saundaryalahari by A. Kuppuswami Rashtriya, Sanskrit Samsthanam, New Delhi
3. Soundarya Lahari by Narayan Das Ramakrishna mission Narendar Pur, Kolkata

[English rendering by Varni Paratpar Swarup. The original Sanskrit was a paper read by Dr. Arati Sharma [asst. professor] LBS Sanskrit university, at YTA colloquium]

Pics and poems



Tree of Light

~ Ambika Talwar

Light of door opening
or closing spells "I"
Journey begins
endless
clarifications
settling of dust particles
storms on open roads

Parted eyes
hands shielding from sun
glare widens
a landscape you cannot
gaze at

Journey begins with a decision
a moment's realization
opens a door – wild longing
Flight of song-filled
silent birds love
achingly fill sky – nightly
splintered with stars
Keep gazing
so there is no difference
between a door closed or open
Just a crack in the cosmos
an "I" that begins to glow
spills all into
bucket of dew fall
Tears of penitence puddle
In dust – cleanse the eyes
gazes melt away
this path so feet
may touch-kiss the dirt
once in a while... so good for soul
In far distant horizon
gazes a tree of light
witness to our every movement
when we realize who we are

[Prof Ambika Talwar teaches creative art in California, U.S., and an Indian American poetess with a bent for eastern metaphysics. Most of her poems are inspired by mystic insight]

PRATYABHIJNA MADE EASY

Pratyabhijna Hridayam as the author himself proclaims is compiled for neophytes who are not quite at home with grammar and logic but devout and docile. Already easy in its ilk, we are rendering it easier for a person who may not be knowing Sanskrit but would like to learn this “canon of pleasurable means” - Sukhopaya.

स्वेच्छया स्वभित्तौ विश्वमुन्मीलयति।।

(Sutra 2) : *Svechhaya Svabhittau Visvam Unmeelayati* (Translation) - She unfolds the universal phenomena within the domain of her own ideal substratum. She unfolds the entire universe within herself out of her own sheer will, like an artist would unfold his/her imagination on a canvas (Exposition) *Svecchaya* - Without any other impetus or motivation of Brahma, Vishnu or Shiva i.e. ‘of her own accord’. There is a legend in the Vedas which tells us that when Brahma was born he didn’t know who he was. This notion of ignorance about himself scared him and suddenly he heard two alphabets त् and प echoing in the waves of the ocean of causation. These were the 17th and 21st consonants of the Sanskrit language which put together form the word ‘tapa’ तप meaning ‘do penance’. Brahma did penance and received the knowledge of the Vedas in the form of *Omkar* and the knowledge of his essential nature as *aham अहं*. Thus he knew himself i.e. his essential nature and feared no one anymore. When he wasn’t aware of his essential nature he was scared but later he mused, “There is no one besides me, so who do I fear?” Fear comes from someone else, from the feeling of duality. Only after Brahma’s ignorance was over he acquired the knowledge of creating the universe. Brahma received motivation to create from *Chit Shakti*. Likewise, Vishnu sustains this universe only after being motivated by Chit Shakti and the same holds true for the annihilator Rudra as well. Rudra too annihilates at the command of Devi. Ishwara relinquishes and veils himself but only when prompted by Chit Shakti. Sadashiva redeems but not independently rather only when inspired by the aspect of Chit Shakti called Anugraha Shakti. So all the fivefold actions take place due to the motivation provided by Chit Shakti itself. She (Chit Shakti) does dominate all five, Brahma, Vishnu, Rudra, Ishwara and Sadashiva to receive her benevolence in the form of Jnana, Ichha, Kriya, Chit and Para Shakti. Thus they are able to carry out the five functions which will be discussed later in detail (Sutra 10: Tathapi Tadvat Panch Krityani Karoti). Chit Shakti, on the other hand, functions independently. A passage from *Atma Suktam* in Rig Veda has Chit Shakti saying: “I alone blow freely like wind creating the entire conglomeration of ‘*Bhuvanas*’ (celestial realms). At the same time, I transcend the earth, heavens, space - this is my magnality ‘*Aham eva vata iva pravami*’ “I am not prompted like Brahma, Vishnu, etc., rather I motivate them” In this aphorism, Chit Shakti speaks in the first person in the form of the daughter of Rishi Vagambhrishi whom she possesses. This explains the meaning of the word ‘*Svecchaya*’. Svatantraya of two types is referred to as Svecchaya. If Chiti is prompted by any entity besides herself there will be a conflict with the notion of ‘Svatantraya’. Hence Chiti will cease to be Chiti i.e. Consciousness. In *Vivekachudamani*, Adi Shankara says, “*Niyamyah Niyama Nah*” “The one who is regulated cannot be the regulator thus if any other entity motivates Chiti, she won’t remain Chiti anymore. Bhittau - *Bhitti* means a wall, canvas, medium or a screen and *Bhittau* means on the screen/wall/canvas/medium. She (Chit Shakti) is herself the screen or the substratum. The screen on which creation unfolds does not lie anywhere else outside her. Thus she is the painter, she is the screen, she is the colours and she herself is the painting.

Unmeelanam - In most of the schools of metaphysics, the creation is conceptual and not material. This mystic form of conceptualization is called *Unmeelanam*. When Chit Shakti opens her eyes, she unfolds the all 35 tattvas (elements) which form her world view. These elements are not created. The unfolding of the already existent phenomenon is called *Unmeelanam*. Since nothing beyond her predates within which to unfold this universal phenomenon, she is herself the substratum or the Bhitti lit wall or canvas. There is an analogy of a town reflected in a mirror. The township of 34 elements is reflected in the mirror of *Vimarsha* within the domain of *Prakasha*. Hence the universal phenomena are not different or distinguished from *Prakasha* though it does appear so. To

understand the nature of this universal manifestation, Sutra 3 says, “*Tannana Anurupa Grahya Grahak Bhedat.*” From YTA CLASSROOM [STUDY CIRCLE]

WISDOM FROM SHIVA’S RATTLE DRUM 13th

Abstract

The three dental and palatal syllables denote the three gunas which spring forth from owing to a disturbance in the equilibrium in Prakriti and her abode - *Purusha* which has been explained in the previous aphorism as manifesting in the form of guttural and labial consonants. These are also related to the three states viz. waking, dreaming and dreamless sleep. These three gunas are ubiquitous and motivate all beings. These three gunas are the toys with which the lord carries out his sporting of creating sustenance and dissolution.

Keywords

Gunas, Mahadeva, the states, sporting, with attributes and the attributeless, dental, lingual dental and palatal sounds.

Eastern meta-physicists usually maintain that the Samkhya philosophy predates most of the other schools of thought. This was preached by one of the incarnations of Vishnu called Kapil to his mother Devhuti who was the first recipient of this wisdom. The first exponent of this doctrine which was also the author of compilations and aphorisms of Samkhya was instructed by Kapil to seers like Vedhu, Asuri, Panch, Shikha, etc. through mystic communion. This revived the school of Samkhya to the ontological form in which we have it today. The origin of this doctrine as such dates back to creation itself since Shiva’s rattle-drum beats have all the cache of philosophic thoughts encrypted in them. This mystery was unfolded when it was discovered that Nandikeshwara alone could have an intuitive insight into the metaphysical import of these aphorisms - the rest e.g. *sanak sanadan sanatkumar shukshounak, Patanjali, vyaghrapad, vashishtha*, etc. could comprehend only what it took to vindicate their respective schools of thought. The main objective of playing these beats could have been to redeem the four enlightened lads of Brahma the creator who had as it was fallen into the abyss of the nether world. There are fourteen realms in all and they had to be redeemed and uplifted from their conditionings hence the fourteen beats. Till Nandikeshwara confined the arcane meaning of the aphorisms to other listeners, for them, they were just mumbo jumbo or abracadabra.

Sage Upamanyu, a recent commentator on the verses of Nandikeshwara says that since the wisdom of the self cannot be conveyed through any verbal or gesticulatory means - the Lord, the supreme preceptor encrypted the divine wisdom and conveyed them through these beats which as the tantric tradition goes are eternal or the quanta of eternal wisdom in which word and meaning are homogeneously situated. Each aphorism can be evaluated in terms of an independent school of thought or integrated with other aphorisms or even as a part of the entire sequence of the fourteen Shiva sutras. This thirteenth one has three syllables in it and is rather a continuum of the preceding one which prophesies the origin of *Purusha* and *Prakriti* from the twelfth beat. The three syllables comprise the fourteenth aphorism. It may be hard to believe as to how these dental and palatal sounds could have emanated from the *damaru* or rattle drum but I have personally heard one tabla maestro play these beats ditto. An expert chode or damaru player can produce these beats by playing the damaru so softly that the two threads with a knot tied at the end of each one just brushed both surfaces of the rattle drum. Sha sa sha. One of these is pronounced as dental, the other one is palatal and the third one is lingual palatal. These three are related to the three states and the three gunas viz. *sattva raja and tamas*. These are the continuations of *Prakriti* and *Purusha* which on uniting reverse the process and while their separation leads to the expansion of the universal phenomena.

These three gunas which signify brilliance, dynamics and inertia are quite decisive when it comes to specifying certain phenomena. The Geeta has devoted an entire chapter to this exposition. Analysis of three states of waking dreaming and sleeping is also attributed to these three gunas. The process of universal manifestation described in terms of three gunas - *sattva* pertains to sustenance and *tamas* to dissolution whereas *rajas* is related to creation. Since these three functions are also perpetuated and frequented alternatively, their respective impetus generates moods, mindsets and physical changes accordingly. These *krityas* as the tantras call them become nine and sixteen as per the mode of combination and permutation creation sustenance and dissolution of creation, sustenance of creation sustenance and dissolution. Creation sustenance and Dissolution of dissolution. These nine modes comprise the nine peripheries of the sacred Shrichakram. The Vedic tradition of metaphysics attributes these gunas to the three states of waking dreaming and sleeping. Turya or the transcendental states pervades all three and their combinations as there are sixteen states in all which accrue from a combination of three gunas and the turya which is imbibed in all three states. The whole universal phenomics embrace the entire gamut of variegation of the universal phenomena.

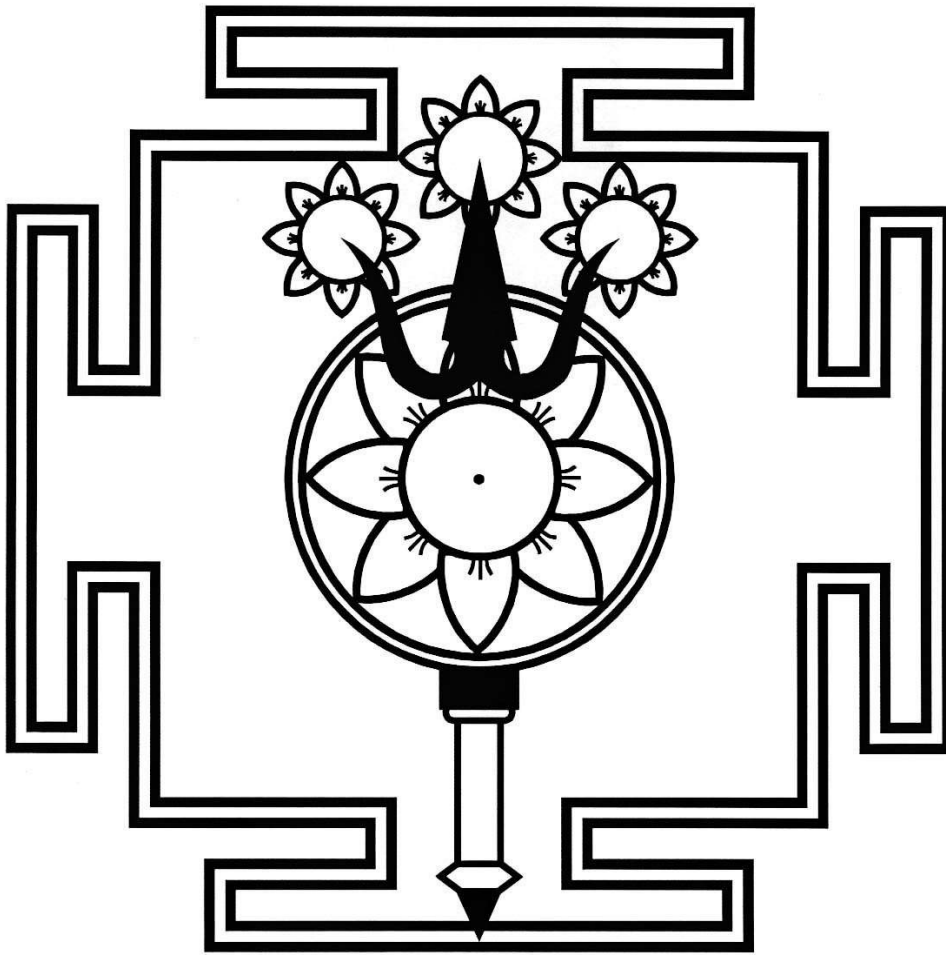
Gunas can be viewed as a sporting of the three gunas. Various characteristics have been attributed to these gunas. So we can establish that the universal phenomena are contained in these three syllables comprising the thirteenth beat Shiva's rattle drum - the last one is to transcend this and become one with the Lord.

Three gunas and the threefold senses – mind, reason and ego. The agamas relate the three gunas to mind ego and reason or man, buddhi and ahankara in the case of an empirical soul who is nothing else but the Pashupati who has descended from the magnanimity of his Parameswara status and is sporting as a pashu. Purusa comes to be conditioned as these three gunas - and thus, the cognitive faculties of ego, volition and imagination or ideation. These further reciprocate the trail of expansion and through the limitations of sense perceptions right up to the element of earth which is considered as the lowest rung in the ladder of the phenomena consisting of thirty-six elements.

Arjuna! *sattva* generates joy and comfort, *rajas* action and dynamism and *tamas* leads to sloth, lethargy and drowsiness. All these gunas are binding so one should strive for transcending them. Elsewhere in the Geeta the Lord says that the entire Vedic revelation is conditioned by these three gunas, Arjun you become *nistraigunya* or the one who is beyond. The idea of this aphorism is to confine everything within the pale of the three gunas and finally transcend the entire trail of the three gunas and their effects in one sweep, as we shall learn in the exposition of the last aphorism.

Since the word according to the agamas predates its meaning counterpart the three syllables of the thirteenth beat, owing to their origin in the eternal word of god these also assert the primordial word or *Shabd Brahman* as the source of all metaphysical thought. “*Tad bhumika sarv darshan sthitayah*” All of these eleven creeds are various expressions of the singular absolute principle which are adapted to befit the competence and temperament of various aspirants. It goes without saying that these aphoristic beats from Shiva's rattle drum are the source of all the wisdom upon the earth which developed later on into a multi ferrous conglomerate of human thought as we find them today. The method of thought transcendence and communion with the eternal word of God leads us to the source of the universal phenomena which is nothing else but our own essential nature. to be continued ...

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